Ministering & Ward Council Tool

How to get access, install it on your phone, and use it

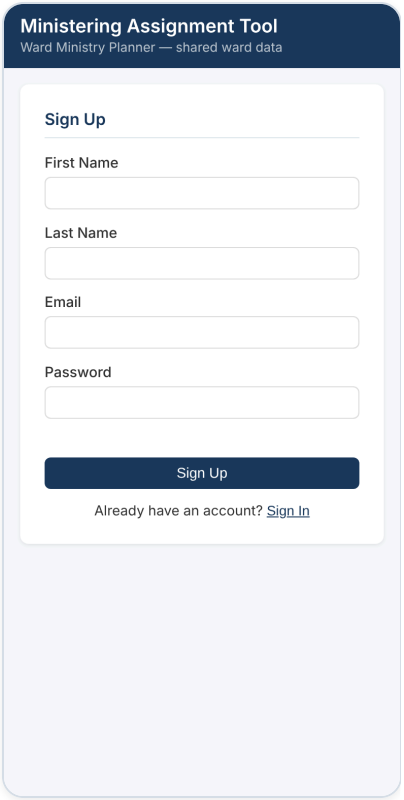
The tool is a shared, private workspace where ward leaders keep ministering assignments current and follow up together on members: new move-ins, people the council is watching over, and who is doing what next. Everyone works from the same live copy, so a note you add is there for the rest of the council the next time they open it.

https://micahj145.github.io/LDS-Ministering-Assignment-Tool/

Please keep it confidential. The tool holds members' names, addresses, phone numbers and personal notes. Treat everything in it as you would anything said in a ward council or presidency meeting: use it only for your calling, and don't share it, or screenshots of it, with anyone outside the council. Nothing is stored on your phone; it's all kept in the ward's secure online account.

1. Get access

1. Open the link above.
2. Tap **Sign Up** (on the sign-in screen, use the link under the button), then enter your first and last name, email and a password. Use your real name; it's what others see on your notes and in the list of people to tag.
3. Check your email for a **verification link** (look in spam if it isn't there) and open it. Then go back to the tool and tap **I've verified — continue**. This confirms the email address is really yours.
4. You'll see **Awaiting Approval**. The site admin approves new accounts, usually within a day. Then sign in with the same email and password.



Creating an account

Everyone sees every tab, including all the ministering lists. Your role, which the admin sets, decides which ministering lists you can change:

Role	Can change
Ward council	Notes, goals and everything outside the ministering lists; the ministering lists are view-only (you can still add notes).
Elders quorum presidency	Also the Brothers pool, the EQ household pool, and Current and Draft Ministering Brother Assignments.
Relief Society presidency	Also the two Sisters pools, the RS household pool, and Current and Draft Ministering Sister Assignments.

2. Install it on your phone

Installing gives you an app icon that opens the tool full-screen. It's the same tool as the website, with nothing to buy and nothing from an app store. You stay signed in when you close it.

iPhone / iPad (iOS 16.4 or newer)

1. Open the link in **Safari**.
2. Tap the **Share** button (square with an arrow).
3. Choose **Add to Home Screen**, then **Add**.
4. Open the tool from the new icon and sign in there once. The Home Screen app keeps its own sign-in, separate from Safari.

Android

1. Open the link in **Chrome**.
2. Tap **Install** when Chrome offers it, or open the ⋮ menu and choose **Install app** (or **Add to Home screen**).
3. Open it from the new icon and sign in.

If the icon has a small Chrome logo on its corner, it's only a shortcut. Remove it and use **Install app** instead, so notification dots appear on the right icon.

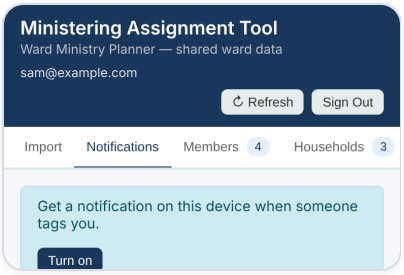
On a computer the website works as it is. In Chrome or Edge you can also install it from the install icon in the address bar.

3. Turn on notifications

When someone tags you on a note, or changes something for a household you follow (section 7), the tool can alert your phone.

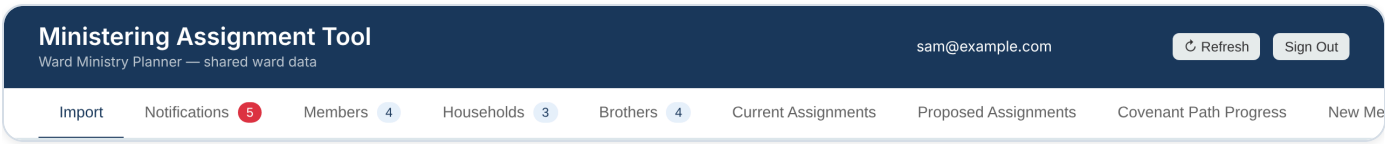
1. Open the installed app and go to the **Notifications** tab.
2. Tap **Turn on**, then **Allow** when your phone asks.

- Do this **once on each device** you use. You can **Turn off** on the same tab at any time.
- **iPhone:** this only works in the Home Screen app, not in Safari. The tool tells you if you're in the wrong place. Your unread count also appears on the app icon.
- **Android:** the icon shows a dot (or a number on some phones) while there's an unread notification.
- Alerts only say who did it, for example "Ana Reyes tagged you on a next step" or "Ana Reyes updated a household you follow." Member details never appear on your lock screen; open the app to see them.
- If you have the app open when you're tagged, a banner appears in the app instead of a phone notification.



Turning on notifications

4. Finding your way around



Tab	What it's for
Notifications	Everything you've been tagged on, plus updates for households you follow, newest first.
Identifiers	Imports markers from LCR (no calling, YSA, part-member, upcoming birthdays), shown as coloured dots beside names everywhere (section 11).
Unit Statistics	Ward totals, Quarterly Report, Key Indicator trends and Family History activity, imported from LCR (section 10).
Messages	Private conversations with other users, and restricted notes only certain people can see (section 8).
Import	Loading member and household lists exported from LCR. Most people won't need it.
Members / Households	The ward lists, each with notes. Households also show whether they're *In Pool* for ministering.
Brothers / Sisters	Who can minister (the ministering pool), and for sisters who should receive ministering sisters (the receives pool).
Current / Draft Ministering Brother & Sister Assignments	Current mirrors LCR (imported); Draft is the presidency's working plan, promoted to Current when it's done.
Covenant Path Progress	The council's shared lists (New Members, Returning Members, People Being Taught), each person with Goals and Notes, and a Follow button.
New Member Move Ins / Move Outs	Households moving in, with a status, Next Steps and Notes, plus a record of who has moved out.

Press ↻ Refresh before you make changes if others may have been working in the tool. It doesn't update live while open, and when two people save at almost the same moment, the later save wins. A quick Refresh first avoids overwriting someone else's work. Closing and reopening the app does the same thing.

5. Notes, goals, next steps and tagging

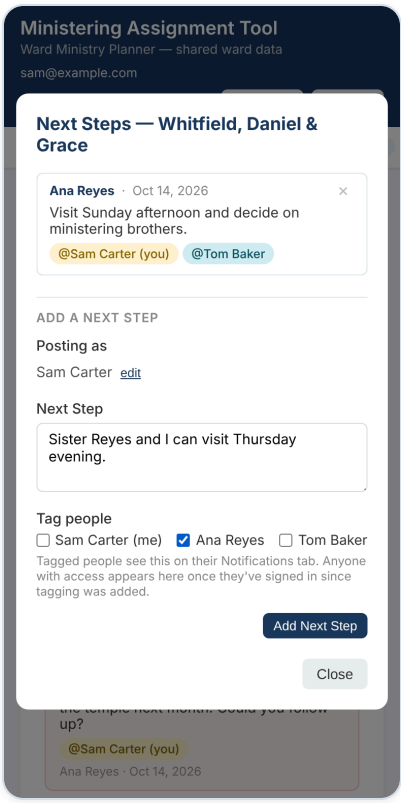
Wherever you see a **Notes**, **Goals** or **Next Step** button, it opens a running log: each entry is dated and signed with your name.

1. Tap the button to open the log.
2. Type your entry.
3. Under **Tag people**, tick anyone who needs to see it or act on it. You can tag yourself as a reminder.
4. Tap **Add**.

People you tag see it on their Notifications tab and, if they've turned notifications on, get an alert on their phone. Tagging yourself never sends you an alert.

The list of people you can tag shows everyone with access who has signed in since tagging was added. If someone is missing, ask them to open the tool once.

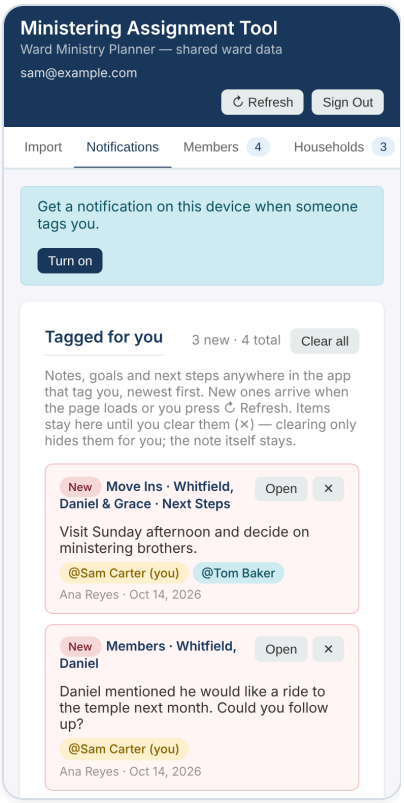
On Covenant Path Progress, a person's Notes also show notes written about that person anywhere else in the tool, labelled with where they came from. Removing one there only hides it from that list.



Adding a next step and tagging

6. The Notifications tab

- Lists every note, goal and next step that tags you, newest first, with where it is (for example, *Move Ins · Whitfield · Next Steps*).
- Items you haven't seen yet are marked **New**, and the tab shows how many. Opening the tab marks them read.
- **Open** takes you straight to that log so you can reply or add the next step.
- Tapping a phone notification opens this tab.
- Items stay on the tab until you clear them. Tap **✕** on one item, or **Clear all** at the top of each section (*Tagged for you* and *People and households you follow*). Clearing only hides an item from your own list; the note itself stays for everyone else.



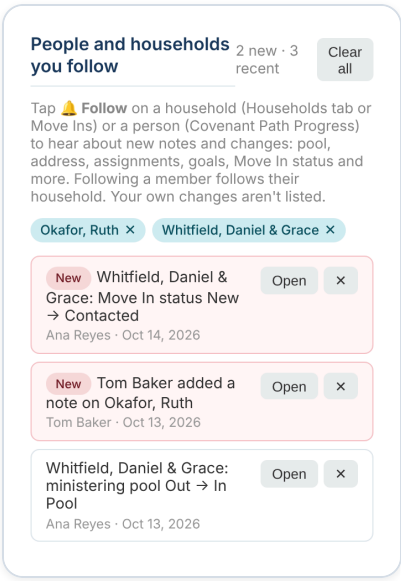
Your tagged items

7. Following people and households

If you're watching over someone, tap 🔔 **Follow**: next to their household on the **Households** tab, their row on **Move Ins**, or their name on **Covenant Path Progress**. The button changes to ✓ **Following**. Following a ward member follows their whole household; following someone on People Being Taught follows just their entry (goals and notes).

From then on, whenever someone changes anything for anyone in that household, it's listed under **People and households you follow** on your Notifications tab. That covers new notes, goals or next steps, the ministering pool, address or phone, ministering assignments, Move In status, and people added or removed. If phone notifications are on, you also get an alert.

- Tap **Open** to go straight to the note or the right tab.
- Your own changes aren't listed.
- Alerts are grouped, at most one every few minutes, so a burst of edits doesn't buzz you repeatedly. The list always shows everything.
- To stop, tap ✓ **Following** again, or the ✕ next to the household's name on the Notifications tab.



Updates for households you follow

8. Messages and restricted notes

For things only certain council members should see, use the **Messages** tab. These are kept apart from the rest of the tool: **the database itself refuses anyone who isn't included**, including other users of the tool. They aren't end-to-end encrypted, so the site admin could reach them through the database console. Matters such as worthiness or abuse belong in person with the bishop, not in writing here.

Direct messages

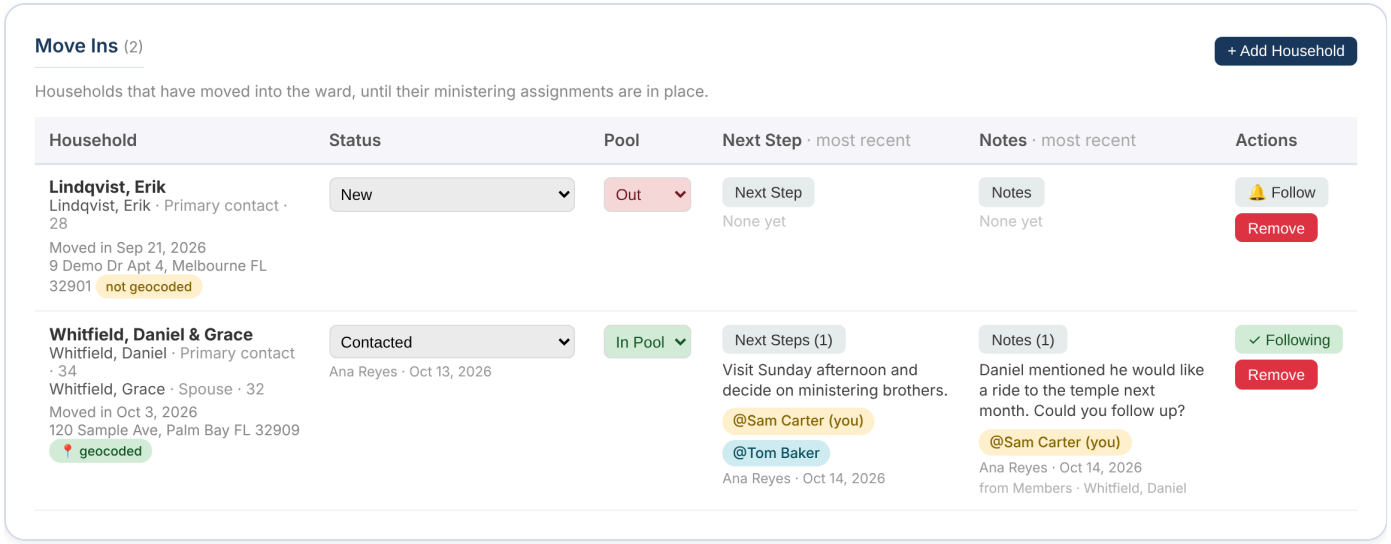
- Tap **+ New conversation**, tick one person (or several for a small group) and tap **Start**.
- Type and tap **Send** (or Ctrl+Enter on a computer). Replies appear without refreshing.
- **+ Add people** brings someone in; they can read the earlier messages too. **Leave** removes the conversation from your list.
- Tap **delete** under any message you sent to remove it for everyone. Nothing is deleted automatically.

Restricted notes

- Open the **Notes** window for a household, member, companionship, or a person on Covenant Path Progress or Move Ins. Under 🔒 **Restricted notes**, tap **+ Restricted note**, write it, tick who can see it, and Save.
- Only you and the people you ticked will ever see it, in that Notes window and on their Messages tab. Only you can edit it, change who can see it, or delete it (✕).

The Messages tab shows how many messages and newly shared notes you haven't seen. With phone notifications on, you get an alert that says only who sent it ("New message from Ana Reyes"), never what it says.

9. New Member Move Ins / Move Outs



Move Ins

Each household that has moved in gets one row, which stays until its ministering is in place.

- **Status:** New → Contacted → Ministering pool decided → Ministering assignments done. The row shows who last changed it, and when.

- **Pool:** whether the household is to be ministered to (In Pool / Maybe / Out). This is the same setting as on the Households tab, so changing it in either place changes both.
- **Next Step:** the running "what happens next and who is doing it" log. Tag the people responsible.
- **Notes:** anything else about the household, including notes written about them elsewhere in the tool.
- **Split…** appears if roommates with different surnames ended up in one household, and separates them.

If you've been tagged on the latest next step for a household that isn't finished, the tab shows a reminder, and the tab button says how many are waiting for you.

Importing the LCR reports

Usually done by one person the ward has asked. Each report has two buttons, one above the other:

Button	What happens
Fetch/Print/Download	Opens that report in LCR in a new browser tab (sign in to LCR if asked). Use LCR's print button and choose *Save as PDF*, or download it, so the PDF is saved on your device. **On an Android phone:** tap *Share*, then *Print*, and pick *Save as PDF* as the printer. **On an iPhone:** tap *Share*, then *Print*, then the share icon in the print screen and *Save to Files*.
Import	Pick the PDF you just saved. **Members Moved In:** shows a review first. Anyone missing from Members or Households is added, new addresses are placed on the map, and each household goes onto Move Ins. If people share an address but not a surname (roommates, say), you're asked whether they're one household or separate ones. Existing records are never overwritten, only blanks filled in. **Members Moved Out:** matches each person to the records by name, checked against their age, and shows the matches. Only confirmed matches are ticked. Nothing is removed until you confirm. Removed people are listed under *Moved Out* for three months.

The PDF is read in your browser; it isn't uploaded anywhere. Only what you confirm is saved.

Importing from LCR (Covenant Path Progress tab)

The **Import from LCR** card at the top of Covenant Path Progress has a **Fetch/Print/Download** and an **Import** button for each list: New Members, Returning Members and People Being Taught. **LCR has no export or download button for these pages**, so you print the web page itself to a PDF from your browser:

1. Tap that list's **Fetch/Print/Download**. LCR opens on the matching tab (sign in if asked).
2. Print the page to PDF. **Computer:** Print (Ctrl+P), then choose *Save as PDF* as the printer. **Android (Chrome):** ⋮ → Share → Print, then pick *Save as PDF* as the printer. If the page opened somewhere with no Print option (for example inside the Google app), tap ⋮ → *Open in Chrome* first.
3. Back in the tool, tap the same list's **Import** and pick that PDF. You'll see everyone on the page before anything is saved. **New and Returning Members:** people matched in Members are ticked; anyone *Not in Members yet* can be ticked to add by name. **People Being Taught:** everyone found is ticked and added by name. Untick anyone you don't want.
4. Anyone on the list who isn't on the page any more is listed separately. Nothing is removed unless you tick it, and you can always remove someone later with their **Remove** button.

The short line LCR shows under each name (for example "Member for 3 months") is kept under the name with the date of the import; re-importing every month or so keeps it current. Attendance and friends in the Church aren't copied in, since LCR already shows them.

10. Unit Statistics

A dashboard of ward totals from four LCR reports: **Unit Statistics**, the **Quarterly Report**, **Key Indicators and Trends** and **Family History Activity**. They hold counts and percentages only, no names. To update one, use the same steps as the other LCR imports: tap that report's **Fetch/Print/Download**, sign in to LCR if asked, print the page to PDF (computer: Ctrl+P → *Save as PDF*; Android Chrome: ⋮ → Share → Print → *Save as PDF*), then tap its **Import** and pick the file. You'll see what was found before anything is saved.

- **Unit Statistics**: membership totals by group. Each import is kept, so the numbers show ▲/▼ change since the previous import.
- **Quarterly Report**: each quarter you import is kept separately. Pick a quarter (up to three years back) from the list; one you haven't imported says so. To fill it in, choose that quarter in LCR, print it and import it. Convert names on the report aren't saved.
- **Key Indicators**: in LCR, tick the indicators and choose how many quarters (2–16) before printing. Each import adds or updates the quarters it contains and keeps the rest. In the tool, tick which indicators to chart and choose how many recent quarters to show.
- **Family History Activity**: members submitting names by month (this year against last), the bar charts and the year-to-date submitters table. Each import replaces the previous one.

The Key Indicators and Family History numbers are read from LCR's charts, so they're whole numbers exactly as LCR plotted them.

11. Identifiers

Small coloured dots beside people's names, for awareness while you work with them. They show wherever names appear: Members, Households, Brothers, Sisters, all four ministering assignment tabs (including the pickers), Covenant Path Progress and Move Ins. A legend sits at the top of each of those tabs. Hover over a dot, or tap it on a phone, to see what it means.

Dot	Meaning
Grey	No calling (on LCR's Members Without Callings report).
Blue	A young single adult.
Amber	A part-member household, and everyone in it.
Pink	A birthday in the next two weeks; tap it for the date. Only the month and day are kept, never the year.

On a household, fainter dots mean one of its members has that marker; the hint names who.

To update one, use the same steps as the other LCR imports on the **Identifiers** tab: Fetch/Print/Download, print to PDF, then that report's Import. Each import replaces that marker for everyone, so someone no longer on the report loses it. Names on the report that aren't in Members are listed so you can import the member list again. The Members and Households filters can show just the people with a marker.

12. Ministering assignments

Four tabs: **Current** and **Draft Ministering Brother Assignments**, and **Current** and **Draft Ministering Sister Assignments**. Current is what LCR has; Draft is the presidency's working plan. Everyone can see all four; the EQ presidency changes the brother lists and the Relief Society presidency the sister lists. Anyone can add notes.

- **Importing Current from LCR** (on either Current tab): tap **Fetch/Print/Download** to open LCR's Ministering Assignments page (Individuals tab), print it to PDF, then **Import**. The review shows how many brothers' and sisters' companionships were found, and lists married couples and anyone not in Members so you can say which list they belong on. Saving replaces Current (the side your role can change); notes on companionships with the same ministers are kept. Drafts aren't touched.
- **Drafts:** **Copy to Draft** starts a draft from Current; **Promote All from Draft** makes the draft the new Current.
- **Pools:** the Brothers tab's pool marks who the EQ presidency is considering as ministering brothers, and the Households tab's **EQ Pool** which households they'll assign. The Sisters tab has a **Ministering Pool** (who could serve as ministering sisters) and a **Receives Pool** (individual sisters to be ministered to), and the Households tab's **RS Pool** marks households for ministering sisters. A sisters' companionship can be given households and individual sisters.
- **Search:** the box above each list finds companionships by name. Choose *Minister* to find who someone ministers with, *Ministered to* to find who ministers to a person (anyone in an assigned household, or an assigned sister), or both. First-last or last-first both work.
- The side columns on each tab show who in the pools isn't assigned yet.

13. Signing in and out

- You stay signed in on your device until you tap **Sign Out**, even after closing the app or restarting your phone.
- On a shared or borrowed device, always tap **Sign Out** when you're done. On a shared device, also tap **Turn off** on the Notifications tab first; signing out alone doesn't stop alerts to that device.
- Forgot your password? On the sign-in screen, enter your email and tap **Forgot password?**. A reset link is emailed to you.
- To change the name others see, tap **edit** next to "Posting as" in any notes window.

14. If something isn't working

What you see	What to do
"Check Your Email"	Open the verification link we emailed you (check spam), then tap **I've verified — continue**. Tap **Resend the link** if it never arrived.
"Awaiting Approval"	Your account is waiting for the admin. Try again later.
"That email already has an account"	Use **Sign In** instead of Sign Up, and use **Forgot password?** if you need to.
"Access Removed"	Your access was cleared. If you should have access, fill in your name and tap **Request access again**; the admin is notified.
"Access Denied"	Your access has been turned off. Contact the site admin if you think that's a mistake.
A tab you expected is missing	Tabs depend on your role (see section 1). Ask the admin if your role needs changing.
Something looks out of date	Press ↻ **Refresh**, or close and reopen the app.
No phone notifications	Check that the Notifications tab says notifications are on for this device. Make sure notifications for the app are allowed in your phone's settings. On iPhone, use the Home Screen app, not Safari. Remember that tagging yourself doesn't send an alert.
Someone isn't in the tag list	They need to open the tool once after tagging was added.

Questions or access requests: contact Micah, the site admin.

Screenshots show made-up sample people, not real members.